

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner who closes the loop from epic to deployment.*

Positioning, nearly ten years translating complex operational workflows into scalable software systems, across regulated B2B environments and cross-functional Agile teams.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY FIRST ADVANTAGE

First Advantage operates at the intersection of compliance, data integrity, and enterprise-scale software — a combination that maps directly to the work I have shipped at Rohde & Schwarz on a government-grade AI data platform and at the Federal Employment Agency on a public analytics product with strict data governance requirements. The job description specifically calls out end-to-end lifecycle ownership — vision through adoption and continuous improvement — which is precisely the scope I held at Emil Group, where I rebuilt delivery stability for a 17-person team and ran weekly product workshops to rebuild client trust. Background screening is a domain where correctness is not a feature but a baseline requirement, and I have operated under exactly that pressure before. *That is the kind of environment where methodical delivery discipline compounds.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not worked directly in the background screening or HR technology industry. What I bring instead is a demonstrated pattern of ramping quickly into regulated, data-intensive B2B platforms — InsurTech, defence AI, public-sector analytics — and delivering production features within weeks, not quarters.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, requirements drafting and edge-case generation
- **GPT**, stakeholder communication and spec review
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-repo implementation support
- **Cursor / VSCode**, day-to-day development environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy flow mockups
- **n8n**, workflow automation and agentic pipeline design
- **Gamma.app**, structured presentation and documentation

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kotlin (Spring Boot), Python, Django, JavaScript, AngularJS, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Jenkins, Bitbucket, Git, Dagster, dbt, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, Ionic, CGM API integration, Shopware, Java, HTML/CSS.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTEST ENGINE & DEV-AGENT FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Crypto market backtesting infrastructure and autonomous multi-agent orchestration, built from scratch.

- Implements a file-queue-based agent loop for autonomous feature delivery across the codebase.
- Architecture uses n8n for orchestration, Replit for environment portability, and LLM-assisted spec generation for test coverage.
- Active development with real trading logic drawn from live experience on Hyperliquid, Jupiter, and 1inch.
- Demonstrates the same autonomous-delivery mindset the Product Owner role requires: scoping, iterating, and shipping without a dedicated engineering team.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT FIRST ADVANTAGE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow existing sprint ceremonies, read the current product roadmap and open epics, map the integration touchpoints between FA systems and partner APIs, and identify where acceptance criteria are weakest.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the backlog.

Run structured refinement sessions with the SWAT POD – QA, architects, developers – to rewrite the most ambiguous stories with clear acceptance criteria and surface any open dependency risks before they hit a sprint.

WEEK 3+

Ship and iterate.

Take ownership of the first deliverable end-to-end: validate with stakeholders, track adoption metrics, and feed findings back into the roadmap as a closed loop.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team at First Advantage,

I am applying for the Product Owner role at First Advantage's Global Operating Centre. The position describes end-to-end lifecycle ownership for new strategic clients – vision, requirements, development, integration, deployment, adoption, and continuous improvement. That scope maps closely to the work I have done across my last three product roles, and I want to be specific about why.

At Rohde & Schwarz, I owned a central AI and data management platform for a multinational defence programme. The environment had strict data governance requirements, multinational stakeholders, and a cross-functional team of architects, data scientists, and frontend and backend engineers. I delivered features end-to-end – from user story to acceptance criteria to implementation support to GitOps rollout – and reduced deployment times from several days to under forty minutes by introducing ArgoCD. At Emil Group, I joined a B2B InsurTech platform mid-crisis: a bloated seventeen-person team, deteriorating sprint discipline, and a

client relationship under real strain. I restructured the team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, and ran weekly product workshops that rebuilt client trust enough to stabilise a contract that had been at risk. That combination of technical fluency and stakeholder discipline is precisely what a Product Owner coordinating a SWAT POD across QA, architecture, and development needs to do.

Your job description flags API integration documentation and communicating functionality to end users as explicit responsibilities. I have shipped both: at CLINET Platforms, I documented and managed a CGM API integration into hospital information system workflows and maintained transparent communication with clinical stakeholders about legacy API constraints and delivery timelines. At the Federal Employment Agency, I introduced Dagster for automated ETL pipeline management and served as Deputy IT Security Officer, which meant owning compliance, governance, and data lineage – disciplines directly relevant to a background screening platform where data integrity is non-negotiable.

I do not have prior experience in the HR technology or background screening industry specifically, and I want to name that honestly. What I do have is a consistent track record of ramping into regulated, data-intensive B2B platforms quickly and delivering production value within weeks. The mechanics of translating business requirements into epics, managing refinement with cross-functional teams, and closing the loop from integration testing to stakeholder sign-off do not change significantly by industry vertical.

First Advantage's emphasis on global scale, automation, and customer success is exactly the environment where structured delivery discipline compounds. I would be glad to discuss how my background applies to the specific portfolio you are building out.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Owner and Product Manager with nearly ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows into scalable, regulated B2B software systems. Proven across defence AI platforms, public-sector analytics, InsurTech SaaS, and mobile healthcare – managing cross-functional Agile teams including QA, architects, data scientists, and frontend and backend engineers. Comfortable taking ownership of end-to-end product lifecycle: from discovery and requirements engineering through sprint delivery, integration, rollout, and adoption tracking. AI-native operator, low ego, high agency.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- End-to-end product lifecycle ownership in regulated B2B environments
- Translating operational requirements into dev-ready epics, stories, and acceptance criteria
- Cross-functional Agile team coordination: QA, architects, developers, data scientists
- Sprint discipline and backlog management under delivery pressure
- API integration documentation and stakeholder communication
- Data governance, compliance, and audit trail ownership
- Rapid onboarding into new domains and legacy system environments
- AI-native workflow tooling applied to product execution
- Founder-level pragmatism: structured, low-ego, results-oriented

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, and GitOps-based rollout with ArgoCD
- Led a cross-functional team including architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA across a government-grade AI data platform
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and audit trails with full data provenance – directly analogous to the verification and data integrity requirements of background screening
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps; unblocked infrastructure issues in OpenShift independently, delivering in one week what had been outstanding from engineering for over a year
- Owned multinational stakeholder communication with transparent documentation of technical constraints and delivery timelines

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Delivered new features on an analytics platform including labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison, and modernised admin tooling – managing the full requirements-to-deployment lifecycle

- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation; standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer (IT-SV) with responsibility for compliance, governance, and data lineage – disciplines directly relevant to a regulated screening platform
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major system upgrades with zero unplanned downtime

EMIL GROUP 2022, 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Owned a B2B SaaS platform serving primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, brokers, and underwriters; delivered modules across product configuration, pricing, underwriting, policy issuance, document management, and workflow automation
- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout
- Re-established sprint discipline and delivery stability: split a bloated 17-person team into smaller Scrum units, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement practices
- Rebuilt client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured communication and weekly product workshops; reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core flows for digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, and patient document storage across iOS and Android
- Documented and managed a CGM API integration into hospital information system workflows; maintained transparent stakeholder communication around legacy API constraints
- Led a small cross-functional team under tight deadlines with strict focus on highest-leverage features

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner, Co-Founder

- Owned backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware

- Designed onboarding to require no technical knowledge and setup under two minutes – demonstrating strong user-centered product thinking in a technically complex domain
- Served as deputy IT security officer alongside product ownership responsibilities

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder, CFO

- Founded a group-based P2P payments product; owned PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype; later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

BUNDESDRUCKEREI – COVID-19 DATA PLATFORM 2021, 2021

Product Owner (RKI projects DIM and DESH)

- Owned secure data structures and identity management for public health infrastructure under acute delivery pressure

AOK HEALTH INSURANCE – ITSCARE 2019, 2020

Proxy Product Owner

- Migrated internal webshop to Shopware including complex catalogue and API integration and configurable approval policies

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · FIRST ADVANTAGE GLOBAL
OPERATING CENTRE

→